

Ibn Tofail University

Analysis V

Problem Set III

Exercise 1:

Let $f : \mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be the function defined by

$$f(x, y) = \begin{cases} \frac{|xy|^\alpha}{x^2 + y^2} & \text{if } (x, y) \neq (0, 0) \\ 0 & \text{if } (x, y) = (0, 0) \end{cases}, \quad \alpha > 0.$$

Determine the values of α for which f is:

- continuous at $(0, 0)$.
- differentiable at $(0, 0)$.

Correction

Answer (no polar coordinates). The function f is

- continuous at $(0, 0)$ exactly when $\alpha > 1$,
- differentiable at $(0, 0)$ exactly when $\alpha > \frac{3}{2}$.

Proof. Using the elementary inequality $2|xy| \leq x^2 + y^2$ (which follows from $(|x| - |y|)^2 \geq 0$), we obtain for $(x, y) \neq (0, 0)$

$$|xy|^\alpha \leq \left(\frac{x^2 + y^2}{2} \right)^\alpha.$$

Thus

$$|f(x, y)| = \frac{|xy|^\alpha}{x^2 + y^2} \leq 2^{-\alpha} (x^2 + y^2)^{\alpha-1}.$$

Write $r^2 := x^2 + y^2$. The right-hand side equals $2^{-\alpha} r^{2\alpha-2}$.

Continuity. If $\alpha > 1$, then $2\alpha - 2 > 0$, so $r^{2\alpha-2} \rightarrow 0$ as $r \rightarrow 0$, and hence $f(x, y) \rightarrow 0$. Therefore f is continuous at $(0, 0)$ for $\alpha > 1$.

To show this condition is sharp, restrict to the line $y = x$. For $x \neq 0$,

$$f(x, x) = \frac{|x \cdot x|^\alpha}{x^2 + x^2} = \frac{|x|^{2\alpha}}{2x^2} = \frac{1}{2} |x|^{2\alpha-2}.$$

If $\alpha = 1$ this equals the constant $1/2$ (so the limit does not go to 0), and if $\alpha < 1$ the expression blows up as $x \rightarrow 0$. Thus continuity at the origin holds iff $\alpha > 1$.

Partial derivatives at the origin. For any h ,

$$f(h, 0) = f(0, h) = 0,$$

so

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial x}(0, 0) = \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{f(h, 0) - 0}{h} = 0, \quad \frac{\partial f}{\partial y}(0, 0) = 0.$$

Hence the only possible differential at the origin is the zero linear map $L \equiv 0$.

Differentiability. f is differentiable at the origin iff

$$\frac{f(x, y) - L(x, y)}{\sqrt{x^2 + y^2}} = \frac{f(x, y)}{\sqrt{x^2 + y^2}} \xrightarrow{(x, y) \rightarrow (0, 0)} 0.$$

From the inequality above,

$$\left| \frac{f(x, y)}{\sqrt{x^2 + y^2}} \right| \leq 2^{-\alpha} (x^2 + y^2)^{\alpha - \frac{3}{2}} = 2^{-\alpha} r^{2\alpha - 3}.$$

Hence a sufficient condition for this quotient to tend to 0 is $2\alpha - 3 > 0$, i.e. $\alpha > \frac{3}{2}$. To see necessity, again use the line $y = x$. For $x \neq 0$ we computed

$$f(x, x) = \frac{1}{2}|x|^{2\alpha-2}, \quad \sqrt{x^2 + x^2} = \sqrt{2}|x|,$$

so

$$\frac{f(x, x)}{\sqrt{x^2 + x^2}} = \frac{\frac{1}{2}|x|^{2\alpha-2}}{\sqrt{2}|x|} = \frac{1}{2\sqrt{2}} |x|^{2\alpha-3}.$$

If $\alpha = \frac{3}{2}$ this ratio tends to the nonzero constant $\frac{1}{2\sqrt{2}}$; if $\alpha < \frac{3}{2}$ it blows up.

Therefore differentiability at $(0, 0)$ fails unless $\alpha > \frac{3}{2}$.

Combining the sufficiency and necessity shows f is differentiable at $(0, 0)$ exactly when $\alpha > \frac{3}{2}$.

Remark. For $(x, y) \neq (0, 0)$ the formula defines a smooth function, so all issues are concentrated at the origin.

Exercise 2:

Study the existence and continuity of the first partial derivatives and the differentiability for the following functions:

$$\begin{aligned}
f(x, y) &= \begin{cases} \frac{x|y|}{\sqrt{x^2 + y^2}} & \text{if } (x, y) \neq (0, 0) \\ 0 & \text{if } (x, y) = (0, 0) \end{cases} ; \\
f(x, y) &= \begin{cases} \frac{xy}{|x| - y} & \text{if } y \neq |x| \\ 0 & \text{if } y = |x| \end{cases} \\
f(x, y) &= \begin{cases} \frac{x^3 - y^3}{x^2 + y^2} & \text{if } (x, y) \neq (0, 0) \\ 0 & \text{if } (x, y) = (0, 0) \end{cases} ; \\
f(x, y) &= \begin{cases} y^2 \sin\left(\frac{x}{y}\right) & \text{if } y \neq 0 \\ 0 & \text{if } y = 0 \end{cases}
\end{aligned}$$

Correction

$$(1) \quad f(x, y) = \begin{cases} \frac{x|y|}{\sqrt{x^2 + y^2}} & \text{if } (x, y) \neq (0, 0), \\ 0 & \text{if } (x, y) = (0, 0). \end{cases}$$

Continuity at (0, 0):

$$|f(x, y)| = \frac{|x||y|}{\sqrt{x^2 + y^2}} \leq \frac{\frac{1}{2}(x^2 + y^2)}{\sqrt{x^2 + y^2}} = \frac{1}{2}\sqrt{x^2 + y^2} \xrightarrow{(x, y) \rightarrow (0, 0)} 0.$$

Hence f is continuous at the origin.

Partial derivatives at (0, 0):

$$f(h, 0) = 0, \quad f(0, h) = 0,$$

so

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial x}(0, 0) = 0, \quad \frac{\partial f}{\partial y}(0, 0) = 0.$$

Continuity of partials: Away from the origin the function is smooth except for the absolute value. Compute for $y \neq 0$,

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial x} = \frac{|y|}{\sqrt{x^2 + y^2}} - \frac{x^2|y|}{(x^2 + y^2)^{3/2}}, \quad \frac{\partial f}{\partial y} = \frac{x \operatorname{sign}(y)}{\sqrt{x^2 + y^2}} - \frac{x|y|y}{(x^2 + y^2)^{3/2}}.$$

The terms contain $\frac{|y|}{\sqrt{x^2 + y^2}}$, which does not approach a single value as $(x, y) \rightarrow (0, 0)$ along different paths. For instance, along $y = x$ one gets $|y|/\sqrt{x^2 + y^2} = 1/\sqrt{2}$, while along $y = 0$ it is 0. Hence neither partial derivative is continuous at the origin.

Differentiability: For differentiability we need

$$\frac{|f(x, y)|}{\sqrt{x^2 + y^2}} = \frac{|x||y|}{x^2 + y^2} \xrightarrow{(x, y) \rightarrow (0, 0)} 0.$$

But along $y = x$, this equals $\frac{1}{2}$, a nonzero constant. Therefore f is *not differentiable* at the origin.

$$(2) \quad f(x, y) = \begin{cases} \frac{xy}{|x| - y}, & y \neq |x|, \\ 0, & y = |x|. \end{cases}$$

Continuity: Along $y = 0$, $f(x, 0) = 0$. Along $y = \frac{|x|}{2}$, $f(x, y) = \frac{x(\frac{|x|}{2})}{|x| - \frac{|x|}{2}} = \frac{|x|}{2}$. This tends to 0 as $x \rightarrow 0$. However, if we approach along $y = |x| - x^2$,

$$f(x, |x| - x^2) = \frac{x(|x| - x^2)}{|x| - (|x| - x^2)} = \frac{x(|x| - x^2)}{x^2} = |x|/x - |x|.$$

For $x > 0$ this equals $1 - x$, for $x < 0$ it equals $-1 - |x|$. The limit depends on the direction and thus does not exist. Therefore f is *not continuous at the origin*. Hence no differentiability is possible there.

$$(3) \quad f(x, y) = \begin{cases} \frac{x^3 - y^3}{x^2 + y^2}, & (x, y) \neq (0, 0), \\ 0, & (x, y) = (0, 0). \end{cases}$$

Continuity: We can factor:

$$f(x, y) = \frac{(x - y)(x^2 + xy + y^2)}{x^2 + y^2}.$$

Then

$$|f(x, y)| \leq |x - y| \frac{x^2 + |xy| + y^2}{x^2 + y^2} \leq 3|x - y|,$$

since $x^2 + |xy| + y^2 \leq 3(x^2 + y^2)/2$. Thus as $(x, y) \rightarrow (0, 0)$, $|f(x, y)| \leq 3|x - y| \rightarrow 0$. Hence f is continuous at the origin.

Partial derivatives at $(0, 0)$: For $h \neq 0$,

$$f(h, 0) = \frac{h^3}{h^2} = h, \quad f(0, h) = -h,$$

so

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial x}(0, 0) = \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{f(h, 0)}{h} = 1, \quad \frac{\partial f}{\partial y}(0, 0) = \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{f(0, h)}{h} = -1.$$

Differentiability: Check whether

$$f(x, y) - x + y = o(\sqrt{x^2 + y^2}).$$

We compute

$$f(x, y) - (x - y) = \frac{x^3 - y^3 - (x - y)(x^2 + y^2)}{x^2 + y^2} = \frac{-xy(x - y)}{x^2 + y^2}.$$

Hence

$$|f(x, y) - (x - y)| \leq \frac{|x||y||x - y|}{x^2 + y^2} \leq \frac{1}{2}|x - y|.$$

Thus

$$\frac{|f(x, y) - (x - y)|}{\sqrt{x^2 + y^2}} \leq \frac{1}{2} \frac{|x - y|}{\sqrt{x^2 + y^2}} \leq \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}.$$

Since this bound tends to 0 as $(x, y) \rightarrow (0, 0)$, the differential exists and equals

$$df_{(0,0)}(h, k) = h - k.$$

Hence f is differentiable at the origin.

$$(4) \quad f(x, y) = \begin{cases} y^2 \sin\left(\frac{x}{y}\right), & y \neq 0, \\ 0, & y = 0. \end{cases}$$

Continuity:

$$|f(x, y)| \leq y^2 \Rightarrow f(x, y) \rightarrow 0 \text{ as } (x, y) \rightarrow (0, 0).$$

So f is continuous.

Partial derivatives at the origin:

$$f(h, 0) = 0 \Rightarrow f_x(0, 0) = 0.$$

For f_y ,

$$\frac{f(0, h) - f(0, 0)}{h} = \frac{h^2 \sin(0)}{h} = 0 \Rightarrow f_y(0, 0) = 0.$$

Differentiability: We check

$$\frac{|f(x, y)|}{\sqrt{x^2 + y^2}} \leq \frac{y^2}{\sqrt{x^2 + y^2}} \leq |y| \xrightarrow{(x, y) \rightarrow (0, 0)} 0,$$

so f is differentiable at the origin with differential $df_{(0,0)} = 0$.

Exercise 3:

Calculate $d_{(1,2)}f(x, y)$ and $d_{(2,3,4)}g(x, y, z)$ where $f(x, y) = \frac{x}{y^2}$ and $g(x, y, z) = \frac{z}{\sqrt{x^2 + y^2}}$.

Correction

(a) Let $f(x, y) = \frac{x}{y^2}$. For $y \neq 0$, the partial derivatives are

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial x}(x, y) = \frac{1}{y^2}, \quad \frac{\partial f}{\partial y}(x, y) = -\frac{2x}{y^3}.$$

Hence the differential (total derivative) at a point (x, y) is

$$d_{(x,y)}f(h, k) = \frac{1}{y^2}h - \frac{2x}{y^3}k.$$

At the specific point $(1, 2)$:

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial x}(1, 2) = \frac{1}{4}, \quad \frac{\partial f}{\partial y}(1, 2) = -\frac{2}{8} = -\frac{1}{4},$$

so

$$d_{(1,2)}f(h, k) = \frac{1}{4}h - \frac{1}{4}k.$$

(b) Let $g(x, y, z) = \frac{z}{\sqrt{x^2 + y^2}}$. For $(x, y) \neq (0, 0)$:

$$\frac{\partial g}{\partial x} = -\frac{zx}{(x^2 + y^2)^{3/2}}, \quad \frac{\partial g}{\partial y} = -\frac{zy}{(x^2 + y^2)^{3/2}}, \quad \frac{\partial g}{\partial z} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{x^2 + y^2}}.$$

Thus

$$d_{(x,y,z)}g(h, k, \ell) = -\frac{zx}{(x^2 + y^2)^{3/2}}h - \frac{zy}{(x^2 + y^2)^{3/2}}k + \frac{1}{\sqrt{x^2 + y^2}}\ell.$$

At the point $(2, 3, 4)$, we have $x^2 + y^2 = 13$, so

$$\frac{\partial g}{\partial x} = -\frac{8}{13^{3/2}}, \quad \frac{\partial g}{\partial y} = -\frac{12}{13^{3/2}}, \quad \frac{\partial g}{\partial z} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{13}}.$$

Hence

$$d_{(2,3,4)}g(h, k, \ell) = -\frac{8}{13^{3/2}}h - \frac{12}{13^{3/2}}k + \frac{1}{13^{1/2}}\ell.$$

Jacobian-row form: $\left[-\frac{8}{13^{3/2}}, -\frac{12}{13^{3/2}}, \frac{1}{13^{1/2}}\right]$.

Exercise 4:

Let $f : \mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ and $g : \mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$ be the functions defined by

$$f(x, y) = \sin(x^2 - y^2) \quad \text{and} \quad g(x, y) = (x + y, x - y).$$

1. Calculate the gradient of f at $(x, y) \in \mathbb{R}^2$.
2. Calculate the Jacobian matrix of g at $(x, y) \in \mathbb{R}^2$.
3. Deduce the Jacobian matrix of $f \circ g$ at $(x, y) \in \mathbb{R}^2$ and give the expression of $D(f \circ g)(x, y)(h, k)$.

Correction**(1) Gradient of f at $(x, y) \in \mathbb{R}^2$:**

Compute the partial derivatives:

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial x}(x, y) = \cos(x^2 - y^2) \cdot 2x = 2x \cos(x^2 - y^2),$$

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial y}(x, y) = \cos(x^2 - y^2) \cdot (-2y) = -2y \cos(x^2 - y^2).$$

Hence the gradient is

$$\nabla f(x, y) = (2x \cos(x^2 - y^2), -2y \cos(x^2 - y^2)).$$

(2) Jacobian matrix of g at $(x, y) \in \mathbb{R}^2$:

$$g(x, y) = \begin{pmatrix} x + y \\ x - y \end{pmatrix}, \quad J_g(x, y) = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{\partial(x+y)}{\partial x} & \frac{\partial(x+y)}{\partial y} \\ \frac{\partial(x-y)}{\partial x} & \frac{\partial(x-y)}{\partial y} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

(3) Jacobian matrix of $f \circ g$ and differential $D(f \circ g)(x, y)(h, k)$:By the chain rule for functions $\mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ and $\mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$:

$$D(f \circ g)(x, y) = \nabla f(g(x, y)) \cdot J_g(x, y),$$

where $\nabla f(g(x, y))$ is a row vector and J_g is a 2×2 matrix.Compute $\nabla f(g(x, y))$:

$$g(x, y) = (X, Y) = (x+y, x-y), \quad \nabla f(X, Y) = (2X \cos(X^2 - Y^2), -2Y \cos(X^2 - Y^2))$$

Then

$$J_{f \circ g}(x, y) = \nabla f(g(x, y)) \cdot J_g(x, y) = (2(X) \cos(X^2 - Y^2), -2(Y) \cos(X^2 - Y^2)) \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{pmatrix}$$

Compute the product:

$$1^{st} \text{ component} = 2X \cos(X^2 - Y^2) + (-2Y) \cos(X^2 - Y^2) = 2(X - Y) \cos(X^2 - Y^2)$$

$$2^{nd} \text{ component} = 2X \cos(X^2 - Y^2) + 2Y \cos(X^2 - Y^2) = 2(X + Y) \cos(X^2 - Y^2)$$

Substitute back $X = x + y$, $Y = x - y$:

$$X - Y = (x + y) - (x - y) = 2y, \quad X + Y = (x + y) + (x - y) = 2x.$$

Hence

$$J_{f \circ g}(x, y) = (4y \cos(4xy), 4x \cos(4xy)).$$

Finally, for $(h, k) \in \mathbb{R}^2$:

$$D(f \circ g)(x, y)(h, k) = 4y \cos(4xy) h + 4x \cos(4xy) k.$$

Exercise 5:

Let $f : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be the function defined by

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} \exp\left(\frac{1}{\|x\|^2 - 1}\right) & \text{if } \|x\| < 1 \\ 0 & \text{if } \|x\| \geq 1 \end{cases},$$

where $x = (x_1, \dots, x_n)$ and $\|x\|^2 = \sum_{i=1}^n x_i^2$.

Show that f is of class C^1 on $\mathbb{R}^n$ and give the expression of its differential.

Correction

Step 1: Smoothness inside the ball $\|x\| < 1$.

Inside the unit ball, the function is a composition of smooth functions: $x \mapsto \|x\|^2$ and $t \mapsto 1/(t - 1)$, then exponentiated. All derivatives exist and are smooth. Therefore $f \in C^\infty(\{x : \|x\| < 1\})$.

Step 2: Partial derivatives at $\|x\| = 1$.

For each $i = 1, \dots, n$, the partial derivative for $\|x\| < 1$ is

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial x_i}(x) = \exp\left(\frac{1}{\|x\|^2 - 1}\right) \cdot \frac{\partial}{\partial x_i}\left(\frac{1}{\|x\|^2 - 1}\right) = \exp\left(\frac{1}{\|x\|^2 - 1}\right) \cdot \frac{-2x_i}{(\|x\|^2 - 1)^2}.$$

Step 3: Continuity at $\|x\| = 1$.

As $\|x\| \rightarrow 1^-$, the term $\frac{-2x_i}{(\|x\|^2 - 1)^2}$ blows up, but the exponential term

$$\exp\left(\frac{1}{\|x\|^2 - 1}\right) \rightarrow 0 \quad \text{faster than any polynomial blow-up.}$$

Hence

$$\lim_{\|x\| \rightarrow 1^-} \frac{\partial f}{\partial x_i}(x) = 0.$$

For $\|x\| > 1$, $f \equiv 0$ and all partial derivatives are 0. Thus the partial derivatives are continuous across $\|x\| = 1$.

Step 4: Differential and class C^1 .

The differential at any $x \in \mathbb{R}^n$ is

$$df_x(h) = \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{\partial f}{\partial x_i}(x) h_i = \begin{cases} \exp\left(\frac{1}{\|x\|^2 - 1}\right) \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{-2x_i}{(\|x\|^2 - 1)^2} h_i, & \|x\| < 1, \\ 0, & \|x\| \geq 1. \end{cases}$$

Since the partial derivatives are continuous everywhere, $f \in C^1(\mathbb{R}^n)$.

Exercise 6:

Let f be the function defined by

$$f(x, y) = \begin{cases} xy \frac{x^2 - y^2}{x^2 + y^2} & \text{if } (x, y) \neq (0, 0) \\ 0 & \text{if } (x, y) = (0, 0) \end{cases}$$

Calculate the partial derivatives at the points $(x, 0)$ and $(0, y)$ with $x, y \in \mathbb{R}$. Calculate the second-order partial derivatives at $(0, 0)$.

Correction

Step 1: Partial derivatives at $(x, 0)$ and $(0, y)$.

(a) Along $y = 0$: $f(x, 0) = 0$. Then

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial x}(x, 0) = \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{f(x+h, 0) - f(x, 0)}{h} = 0,$$

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial y}(x, 0) = \lim_{k \rightarrow 0} \frac{f(x, k) - f(x, 0)}{k} = \lim_{k \rightarrow 0} \frac{xk(x^2 - k^2)/(x^2 + k^2)}{k} = \lim_{k \rightarrow 0} \frac{x(x^2 - k^2)}{x^2 + k^2} = x.$$

(b) Along $x = 0$: $f(0, y) = 0$. Then

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial x}(0, y) = \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{f(h, y) - f(0, y)}{h} = \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{hy(h^2 - y^2)/(h^2 + y^2)}{h} = -y,$$

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial y}(0, y) = \lim_{k \rightarrow 0} \frac{f(0, y+k) - f(0, y)}{k} = 0.$$

Step 2: Second-order partial derivatives at $(0, 0)$.

(a) Mixed partial $\partial^2 f / \partial x \partial y$ at $(0, 0)$:

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial x}(0, 0) = \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{f(h, 0) - f(0, 0)}{h} = 0.$$

Then

$$\frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial y \partial x}(0, 0) = \lim_{k \rightarrow 0} \frac{\frac{\partial f}{\partial x}(0, k) - \frac{\partial f}{\partial x}(0, 0)}{k} = \lim_{k \rightarrow 0} \frac{-k - 0}{k} = -1.$$

(b) Mixed partial $\partial^2 f / \partial y \partial x$ at $(0, 0)$:

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial y}(0, 0) = 0, \quad \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x \partial y}(0, 0) = \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{\frac{\partial f}{\partial y}(h, 0) - \frac{\partial f}{\partial y}(0, 0)}{h} = \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{h - 0}{h} = 1.$$

(c) Pure second-order partials at $(0, 0)$:

$$\frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x^2}(0, 0) = \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial y^2}(0, 0) = 0.$$

Step 3: Summary of partial derivatives.

$$\begin{aligned}
f_x(x, 0) &= 0, & f_y(x, 0) &= x, \\
f_x(0, y) &= -y, & f_y(0, y) &= 0, \\
f_{xx}(0, 0) &= 0, & f_{yy}(0, 0) &= 0, & f_{xy}(0, 0) &= 1, & f_{yx}(0, 0) &= -1.
\end{aligned}$$

Remark: The mixed partials at the origin are not equal, which shows that f is not C^2 at $(0, 0)$.

Exercise 7:

Let f be the function defined by $f(x) = \|x\|$, $\forall x \in \mathbb{R}^n$. Study the differentiability of f on $\mathbb{R}^n$.

Correction

Step 1: Differentiability for $x \neq 0$.

For $x \neq 0$, the norm function can be written as

$$f(x) = \sqrt{x_1^2 + x_2^2 + \cdots + x_n^2}.$$

The partial derivatives are

$$\frac{\partial f}{\partial x_i}(x) = \frac{x_i}{\|x\|}, \quad i = 1, \dots, n.$$

Hence the differential at $x \neq 0$ is

$$df_x(h) = \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{x_i}{\|x\|} h_i = \frac{x \cdot h}{\|x\|}.$$

This shows f is differentiable at every point $x \neq 0$.

Step 2: Differentiability at $x = 0$.

Assume f is differentiable at 0. Then there exists a linear map $L : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ such that

$$\lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{\|h\| - L(h)}{\|h\|} = 0.$$

But $\|h\|$ is positively homogeneous: along h with $\|h\| = 1$,

$$\frac{\|h\| - L(h)}{\|h\|} = 1 - L(h),$$

which must tend to 0 as $h \rightarrow 0$. This is impossible because L is linear, so $L(h)$ cannot equal 1 in all directions.

Conclusion:

$f(x) = \|x\|$ is differentiable on $\mathbb{R}^n \setminus \{0\}$, but not differentiable at 0.